MIL-B-36998B
21 September 1977
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-36998A
26 June 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC RUBBER WARP THREADS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers elastic bandages with rubber warp threads for use in a pressure bandage, support, or binder.

1.2 Classification. The bandages shall be of the following types, classes, and sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 2 inches by 4-1/2 yards
Size 2 - 3 inches by 4-1/2 yards
Size 3 - 4 inches by 4-1/2 yards
Size 4 - 6 inches by 4-1/2 yards

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 -Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 -Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 -Boxes, Setup.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6510

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-TEST METHOD STD - 191 - Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material used in the fabrication of the bandage shall be of a quality that will withstand repeated washing temperature up to 212°F., and drying at surface temperatures up to 220°F., without deterioration of the bandage or the bandage losing its elasticity to the extent specified in 3.5.1. The warp direction of the bandage shall be made of cotton yarn and cotton covered, heat resistant rubber strands. The filling direction shall be made of cotton yarns. The bandage material shall conform to the requirements of table I.

TABLE I. Bandage requirements.

Yarns per inch (minimum)			Weight, ounces per bandage (minimum 1/)	Breaking strength, pounds (minimum)	
Warp		Filling			
Cotton	Elastic	Cotton		Warp	Filling
30	10	60	Size 1 = 0.92 Size 2 = 1.38 Size 3 = 1.84 Size 4 = 2.76	20	85

1/ The weight requirement refers to the finished bandage with sewn ends but without metal clips.

3.2 Color. The bandage shall be dyed flesh color. The dye used shall be nontoxic and shall not irritate the skin.

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3.2.1 Colorfastness to water. The dyed bandage shall show good colorfastness to water when tested as specified in table III.

3.3 Construction. The finished elastic bandage shall be uniformly woven and of one continuous piece. The cut ends of the bandage shall be sewn, or otherwise treated to prevent raveling. When sewn, the stitch type shall be any one of stitch types 501 through 506 inclusive, in accordance with FED-STD-751, using not less than 10 stitches per inch. The bandage shall be clean and evenly and neatly rolled without tension. Each bandage shall be packaged with a minimum of two clips of corrosion-resisting metal for fastening the end of the bandage. The clips may be sewn to the end of the bandage.

3.4 Dimensions. The length of the unstretched bandage shall be not less than 60 inches. The stretched length of the finished bandage shall average a minimum of 162 inches long, with no individual bandage measuring less than 154 inches long. The minimum unstretched width shall be:

Size	Minimum Width (inches)
1	1-15/16
2	2-7/8
3	3-7/8
4	5-7/8

3.5 Elasticity. The finished bandage shall have a minimum elasticity of 120 percent and shall be capable of returning a minimum of 110 percent within one minute when tested as specified in table III.

3.5.1 Elasticity after laundering. The finished bandage after subjection to five launderings shall have a minimum elasticity of 120 percent and shall be capable of returning a minimum of 75 percent within one minute when tested as specified in table III. When clips are sewn to the end of the bandage, they shall not loosen nor become detached during laundering.

3.6 Workmanship. The bandage shall be clean and free of loose threads, ravelings, and any defects which affect its appearance or impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Inspection lot.

4.2.1 Raw materials. An inspection lot for raw material inspection shall be all material produced under the same conditions and controlled to the degree that uniformity of product within the designated lot can be assured.

4.2.2 End product. An inspection lot for inspection of end product shall consist of all bandages of the same type produced under essentially the same conditions and offered for inspection at one time.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and table II. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one bandage.

TABLE II. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Minor defects	II	2.5

4.3.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III. For unstretched length and unstretched width the inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. For all other tests each shall be performed not less than five times for each lot and the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be the bandage. The method of testing specified in FED-TEST METHOD STD-191, whenever applicable shall be followed.

TABLE III. Sampling for tests.

Component (Unit of product)	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure
Bandage	Yarns per inch	Table I	5050
	Weight	Table I	1/
	Breaking strength	Table I	5100 2/
	Colorfastness to water	3.2.1	5630 3/
	Stretched length	3.4	4.5.1.1
	Elasticity	3.5	4.5.3

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TABLE III. Sampling for tests. - Continued

Component (Unit of product)	Characterisitc	Require-ment	Test procedure
	Elasticity after five launderings	3.5.1	4.5.3.1 and 5550
	Width unstretched	3.4	4.5.2
	Length unstretched	3.4	4.5.1

1/ Individual bandage weight shall be determined by weighing the finished bandage with sewn ends, but without metal clips.
2/ The distance between the jaws of the tester shall be one inch apart at the start of test.
3/ Contractor shall submit control samples, test samples and transfer cloth samples (if transfer cloth samples are used) to the contracting officer for approval.

4.4 Examination. The bandages shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with table IV. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed below.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major:	
101	Bandage not one continuous piece.
102	Bandage not clean (free of loose threads, revelings or lint).
103	Bandage having cuts, holes or tears.
104	Bandage without specified number of metal clips.
Minor:	
201	Bandage not neatly or evenly rolled.
202	Bandage having undyed threads.
203	Bandage with pulled or exposed threads (a condition caused by other than snagging by the clips).
204	Bandage having a raveling thread at the stitched end.
205	Bandage supplied with clips having a defective finish.
206	Bandage having specks of foreign matter woven into the fabric.
207	Bandage having discolored threads (i.e., discoloration not due to soiling of the bandage).
208	Bandage having creases and wrinkles.
209	Bandage having loose threads (which will ravel) at the stitched end.
210	Bandage not specified color.

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4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Length, unstretched. The bandage, without tension, shall be laid out, on a smooth horizontal surface. The length shall be measured parallel to the edge using a yardstick, metal tape, or any suitable measuring device graduated in a maximum of 1/4 inch.

4.5.1.1 Stretched length. The bandage shall be laid on a horizontal surface and stretched to limit without application of mechanical force. While in the stretched position, the length of the bandage shall be measured parallel to the edges, to the nearest inch.

4.5.2 Width, unstretched. The bandage shall be measured using a ruler, or any suitable measuring device graduated in a maximum of 1/16 inch.

4.5.3 Elasticity test. A full width bandage (not previously stretched) shall be laid out on a flat horizontal surface without tension. A ten inch portion of the bandage shall be marked off and stretched to 22 inches. The bandage shall remain stretched to 22 inches for one hour, and then released. The marked off portion of the bandage shall be measured again (without tension). The percentage of stretch and return shall be computed as follows:

$$\text{Stretch, percent} = \frac{L_2 - L_1}{L_1} \times 100$$

$$\text{Return, percent} = \frac{L_2 - L_3}{L_1} \times 100$$

Where:

L_1 = Original length, prior to stretching.
L_2 = Stretched length.
L_3 = Relaxed length, after stretching.

4.5.3.1 Elasticity test after five launderings. A full width bandage (not previously stretched) shall be unrolled and subjected to five launderings as specified in Method 5550 of FED-TEST METHOD STD-191, except the markings for shrinkage and pressing are not required. Drying shall be performed in a drying oven at 220°F. Upon completion of the fifth laundry cycle (washing, extracting and drying) the bandage shall be placed in standard atmospheric conditions as specified in section 4 of FED-TEST METHOD STD-191. When the bandage has reached moisture equilibrium it shall be tested as specified in 4.5.3. If clips are sewn to the end of the bandage observe that they have not become loose nor detached.

4.6 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit, intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing twelve bandages, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Individual package. Each bandage shall be wrapped or sealed in kraft paper of suitable weight. Wrapping shall be secured by hemming seam of wrap and folding or twisting ends. As an alternate each bandage may be wrapped and heat sealed in plastic film. The package shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

5.1.2.2 Unit package. Twelve individual packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Boxes conforming to PPP-B-566 shall have the top and bottom closures secured with 2-inch wide tape conforming to PPP-T-76. The tape shall be placed over the center of the closures and extend not less than 2 inches on the front and back sides of the box.

5.1.2.3 Intermediate package. Eighteen size 1, twelve size 2, nine size 3 or six size 4 unit packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Bandages shall be clean, dry and individually packaged in accordance with the contractors commercial practice. Twelve individually packaged bandages shall be further packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two intermediate packages (36 unit packages) of size 1, (24 unit packages) of size 2, (18 unit packages) of size 3 or (12 unit packages) of size 4 bandages shall be packed in an exterior container conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Bandages shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except that the exterior container shall conform to PPP-B-636, class domestic and waterproofing and strapping shall not be required.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged bandages shall be packed in shipping containers that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carriers rules and regulations.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit and intermediate package. Each unit and intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Date of manufacture shall be shown in lieu of date packed. Contract or purchase order number and manufacturer's name and address shall be shown. Marking shall also meet the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and shall include the lot (control) number. In addition, each unit package shall include the following cautionary statement on the package or as an insert:

"This Bandage Has Rubber Threads. It can Cause Circularoty Restriction If Not Correctly Applied. Patient Should Be Cautioned To Check Periodically."

5.3.2 Exterior container. Each exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The lot (control) number shall be shown. The date of manufacture shall be shown in lieu of the date packed.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The bandage covered by this specification is suitable for use as a pressure bandage, support, or binder in treatment of orthopedic and post-operative patients.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. Type and size required (see 1.2).

6.3 This specification covers the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation
6510-00-935-5820	BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC, Rubber Warp Threads, 2 inches by 4-1/2 yards, 12's	Size 1
6510-00-935-5821	BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC, Rubber Warp Threads, 3 inches by 4-1/2 yards, 12's	Size 2
6510-00-935-5822	BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC, Rubber Warp Threads, 4 inches by 4-1/2 yards, 12's	Size 3
6510-00-935-5823	BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC, Rubber Warp Threads, 6 inches by 4-1/2 yards, 12's	Size 4

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6.4 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review Activity:
DoD - MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6510-0619

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE MIL-B-36998B - BANDAGE, COTTON, ELASTIC RUBBER WARP THREADS

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

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